

## Divya Deshmukh's victory showcases the depth of women's chess in India

Indian chess had a **breakthrough** moment on Monday when Divya Deshmukh defeated **veteran compatriot** Koneru Humpy in the final of the FIDE Women's World Cup in Batumi, Georgia. At 38, Humpy is twice Deshmukh's age, which made the final a true **clash** of generations: **Humpy**, the original **trailblazer** of women's chess in India, **became** the country's first woman to **claim** the **grandmaster title**, while Deshmukh is the fastest **comet** to shoot **past** the skies and become a grandmaster. Her **meteoric** rise can be **gauged** from the fact that just last year, she had become the World Junior Champion in the girls' category. Thirteen months later, she's fighting for — and winning — the biggest titles on offer in the senior category.

The **spectacle** of two Indian women fighting it out in the final of the World Cup, an event where 107 players from 46 nations **competed**, **is** special. But what makes the win even more **significant** is the fact that while two Indians were in the final, **two Chinese players** — **former** women's world champion Tan Zhongyi and Lei Tingjie — **were** fighting for third place after losing to the two Indians. China is a **powerhouse** of the women's event, having **given** the world six out of the 17 women's world champions in history. This includes the current women's world champion, Ju Wenjun, and the current World No 1, Hou Yifan. Humpy and Deshmukh defeated four of the nine Chinese players who came to Batumi. The FIDE Women's World Cup was another **demonstration** of India's increasing depth in the women's event. Last year, the Indian women's **team**, **spearheaded** by Deshmukh, **had claimed** a gold medal in the Women's Chess Olympiad, the most **prestigious** team event in the largely individual sport.

The good news for Indian women chess is that it's not just about Deshmukh and Humpy. In Harika Dronavalli, the country has another veteran who has been around for **decades** now. And there are players like Vaishali Rameshbabu and Vantika Agrawal, who will be the **torchbearers** of women's chess for India in the coming decades. At the World Cup, besides Deshmukh and Humpy, Rameshbabu and Agrawal also made it to the quarter finals — India had the most **representation** at that stage. Having **conquered** the Olympiad and the World Cup, **the next step** now for **the likes of** Deshmukh and Humpy **will** be to qualify for the Women's World Championship — and to win it. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

## Vocabulary

1. **Showcase** (verb) – display, exhibit, highlight, present, demonstrate प्रदर्शित करना
2. **Breakthrough** (adjective) – revolutionary, ground-breaking, innovative, trailblazing, pioneering क्रांतिकारी
3. **Veteran** (adjective) – experienced, seasoned, accomplished, expert, mature अनुभवी
4. **Compatriot** (noun) – fellow citizen, countryman, peer, national, co-native हमवतन
5. **Clash** (noun) – conflict, confrontation, collision, encounter, skirmish टकराव
6. **Trailblazer** (noun) – pioneer, innovator, pathfinder, groundbreaker, forerunner अग्रणी
7. **Claim** (verb) – secure, attain, win, acquire, earn प्राप्त करना
8. **Grandmaster title** (noun) – highest chess title, elite rank, top designation, premier honor, master-level award ग्रेंडमास्टर उपाधि
9. **Comet** (noun) – an object in space that looks like a bright star with a tail and that moves around the sun पुच्छल तारा
10. **Past** (preposition) – beyond, over, after, across, through के पार
11. **Meteoric** (adjective) – rapid, spectacular, blazing, swift, dazzling तेजी से उभरता हुआ
12. **Gauge** (verb) – measure, assess, estimate, evaluate, calculate मापना
13. **Spectacle** (noun) – display, show, performance, scene, exhibition दृश्य
14. **Compete** (verb) – contend, vie, challenge, participate, battle प्रतिस्पर्धा करना
15. **Significant** (adjective) – important, notable, meaningful, substantial, major महत्वपूर्ण
16. **Former** (adjective) – previous, ex-, past, earlier, preceding पूर्व
17. **Powerhouse** (noun) – leader, giant, force, stronghold, dominant player महाशक्ति
18. **Given** (preposition) – considering, taking into account, in view of, assuming, due to को देखते हुए
19. **Demonstration** (noun) – display, illustration, presentation, exhibition, proof प्रदर्शन
20. **Spearhead** (verb) – lead, pioneer, drive, initiate, command नेतृत्व करना
21. **Claim** (verb) – assert, obtain, declare, win, achieve दावा करना

22. **Prestigious** (adjective) – esteemed, renowned, respected, celebrated, distinguished प्रतिष्ठित

23. **Decade** (noun) – Period of ten years, दशक

24. **Torchbearer** (noun) – leader, pioneer, standard-bearer, role model, pathfinder अग्रदूत

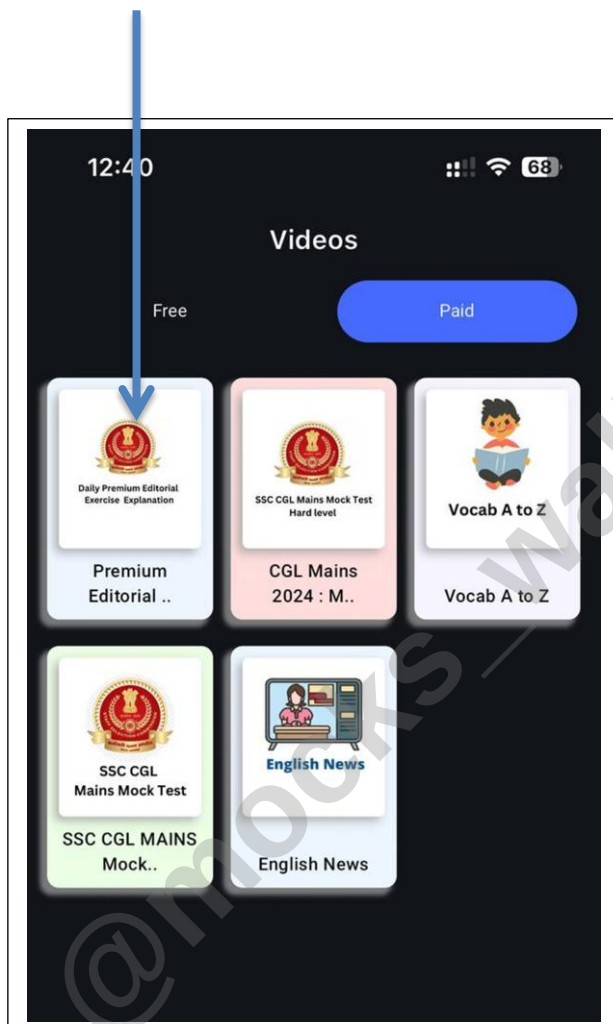
25. **Representation** (noun) – participation, presence, inclusion, involvement, portrayal प्रतिनिधित्व

26. **Conquer** (verb) – win, overcome, triumph, defeat, dominate जीतना

27. **The likes of** (phrase) – such as, for example, people like, examples of, those comparable to जैसे लोग

@mocks\_wallah

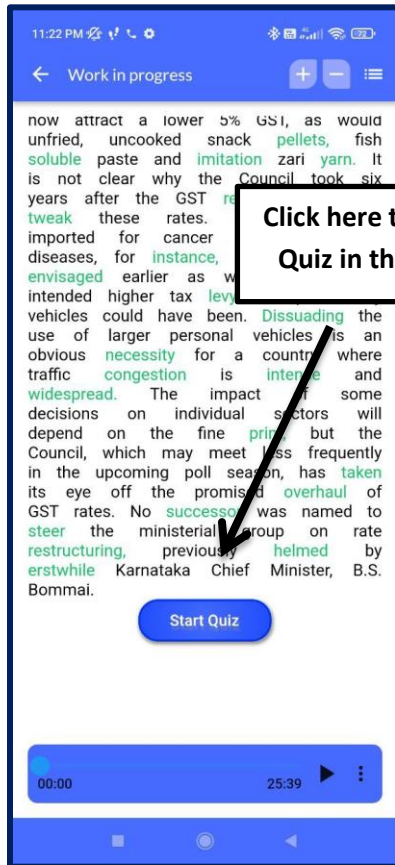
**Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.**



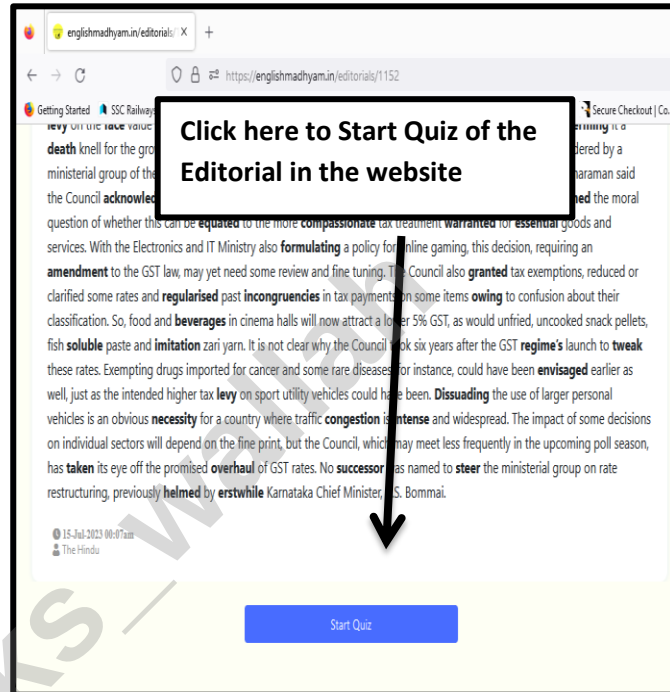
### Summary of the Editorial

1. Historic victory: Divya Deshmukh defeated Koneru Humpy in the final of the FIDE Women's World Cup in Batumi, Georgia, marking a major moment for Indian women's chess.
2. Clash of generations: The final was symbolic — Humpy (38) is twice the age of Deshmukh (19), representing the bridge between pioneers and emerging talent.
3. Humpy's legacy: Humpy was the first Indian woman grandmaster and a trailblazer in Indian women's chess.
4. Deshmukh's rapid rise: Just a year ago, Deshmukh was World Junior Champion; now she's winning major senior-level global titles.
5. All-Indian final: The World Cup final featured two Indian players, showcasing the country's rise in global women's chess.
6. Indian dominance over China: India outperformed China, historically the strongest women's chess nation, with its players losing in the semifinals to Humpy and Deshmukh.
7. China's record: China has produced 6 of 17 women's world champions, including current champion Ju Wenjun and World No. 1 Hou Yifan.
8. Key victories: Indian players defeated 4 of the 9 Chinese participants at the tournament, indicating a power shift in women's chess.
9. Growing depth in India: The performance at the World Cup reflects India's increasing depth and strength in women's chess.
10. Team achievements: In 2024, the Indian women's team won gold at the Women's Chess Olympiad, led by Deshmukh.
11. Veteran support: India's rise is supported by veterans like Harika Dronavalli, a long-time top player.
12. Emerging stars: Talents like Vaishali Rameshbabu and Vantika Agrawal are positioned to carry Indian women's chess forward.
13. Quarterfinal strength: Apart from the finalists, Rameshbabu and Agrawal also reached the quarterfinals, giving India the most players at that stage.
14. World Championship goal: The next step for Indian stars like Deshmukh and Humpy is to qualify for and win the Women's World Championship.
15. Bright future: India's recent performances show that it is becoming a global powerhouse in women's chess, with both talent and depth across generations.

## Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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